

H B L A C K R V E S T



Bill and Frances. A strange guy called Danny. A trip to the sea. Strangers on a beach. An abandoned house.



TOMESHA

A TOMESHA PRODUCTION

BLACK HARVEST (SHORT LIVES-part one)

with

and (in order of appearance)

Kate Yourke and Jim Coleman

Tim Wright, Michael S. Edwards

Mark Boone Jr., Shelby Stone,

Sarah Auld, Martin Widener

written and directed by

director of photography

producer

editors

sound editor

sound recording

music

Guido Chiesa

Frank Prinzi

Louis Tancredi

Christine Vachon, Guido Chiesa

Christine Vachon

Steve Ning

Luca Gasparini, Riccardo Gherardi

Franco Sciancalepore

Tim Wright

The Mirrors - "Hole In My Head"

Husker Du - "Standing By The Sea"

(courtesy SST/Cesstone Music)

16 minutes, black&white, 35 mm, screening ratio 1:1,85, 1986.

TOMESHA PRODUCTIONS

P.O. BOX 40 NYC 10009 212- 529 6799

SYNOPSIS

Bill - disillusioned and unemployed - and Frances - a rebellious taxi driver - decide to go and visit Danny, a strange acquaintance they once met at a Jimi Hendrix memorial. Danny apparently lives in a house overlooking the ocean beach of Montauk. But Bill and Frances joyful ride to Montauk is soon transformed into an enigmatic search for Danny, that ultimately leads to the separation of the two friends.

ON BLACK HARVEST

Looking back at BLACK HARVEST, I can say that I intended to make a film that works like a rock ballad. A ballad because this traditional form of narration is generally based on real events, even if its language inspires a sense of romantic surreality. A "rock" ballad because the film's mood, other than the narration and the soundtrack itself, reminds me of this modern popular culture.

BLACK HARVEST is a pilot, and an exercise, for a projected feature film tentatively entitled DEATH VALLEY to be shot between New York and California, and based on a screenplay by Amos Poe and Guido Chiesa.

The story of DEATH VALLEY revolves around Danny, his group of restless drifters and their search for an utopian land hidden under the desert.

THE FILMAKERS

GUIDO CHIESA

Born in Torino, Italy, 1959. Graduated in Literature in 1983 with a major in Cinema Studies. Before 1983, cinema lecturer in schools; film distribution consultant; writer of essays on Orson Welles and cinema genres. Moved to New York in 1983. Assistant director and production assistant in film and videos by Jim Jarmusch, Amos Poe, Michael Cimino and Nicholas Roeg. American representative for the Youth International Film Festival, Torino. U.S. correspondent for Italian rock and cinema magazines. Writer of books about the contemporary New York filmmakers and the American rock music.

Filmography

GIVE ME A SPELL	1984	20 min., 16 mm.
UN DIEU MANQUE	1984	music video
LIE DETECTOR	1983	45 min., super-8
PSYCHO KILLER	1982	55 min., super-8
COWBOYS IN AFRICA	1980	5 min., super-8
UN MESSAGGERO	1979	40 min., super-8

FRANK PRINZI

NYU film graduate. Credits as filmmaker include SOLDIERS and IN THE RUINS. As director of photography Squat Theatre's LET ME LOVE YOU (DREAMLAND BURNS), Sara Driver's SLEEPWALK, Bette Gordon's THE LADIES LOUNGE, David Gelfand's DOTTIE. He worked as lighting director in STRANGER THAN PARADISE.

LOUIS TANCREDI

NYU film graduate. he works as in production in film and commercials in New York. Credits include films by Bette Gordon, Jim Jarmusch, Sara Driver and Nicholas Roeg. He is currently co-producing a feature for AMERICAN PLAYHOUSE.

CHRISTINE VACHON

Film graduate. Credits include as filmmaker DAYS ARE NUMBERED

and A MAN IN YOUR ROOM. As editor, sound editor or assistant sound editor: Bill Sherwood's PARTING GLANCES, Rachid Kerdouche's HER NAME IS LISA, Jill Godmillov's FAR FROM POLAND.

THE CAST

KATE YOURKE

Performer and visual artist.

JIM COLEMAN

Musician, experimental filmmaker and actor in experimental films.

TIM WRIGHT

Musician. Former member of Pere Ubu and DNA.

MICHAEL SEAN EDWARDS

Theatre actor, dancer and filmmaker. Screen credits include DAYS ARE NUMBERED and LASTING EFFECTS.

MARK BOONE JR.

Theatre actor, often in duo with Steve Buscemi. Screen credits include Eric Mitchell's THE WAY IT IS, Liza Baer's FORCE OF CIRCUMSTANCES and a new film by Jacob Burchardt.

SHELBY STONE

Art history graduate. Video producer in San Francisco. She is currently working for a New York based distribution company.

SARAH AULD

She works as a publicist for several New York rock groups.

MARTIN WIDENER

Theatre actor. Credits include Off-Off Broadway and the Sidney Repertory Co. (Australia) productions.